Well, this time, I decided, we weren't going to make the same mistake again. I knew I had relied too much on the advice of Sears instead of my own instincts and had to take more direct control of the campaign.

I brought everybody together and said we were going to work our tails off in New Hampshire—and we did.

Day after day, we traveled the snow-splattered highways of the state from early in the morning to late at night; I'd speak to anyone who was willing to listen to me, then we'd get back in our convoy of cars and buses and drive someplace else and seldom get to bed before midnight.

I think the loss in Iowa had really whipped up my competitive fires, and I didn't want to lose again.

As I've said, I have often wondered at how our lives can turn on what seem like small or inconsequential events, like my losing the job at Montgomery Ward.

That winter, a brief and seemingly small event, one lasting only a few seconds, occurred in a high school gymnasium in Nashua, New Hampshire, and I think it helped take me to the White House.